

Corpus definitions:

Socialist Writings

- **Seattle DSA:** All blogposts from Seattle DSA (<https://seattledsa.org/category/news/>)
- **Socialist Alternative:** <https://www.socialistalternative.org/tag/seattle/> All posts tagged with Seattle.
- **Seattle Freedom Socialist Party:** Newspaper from the Seattle FSP: <https://socialism.com/freedom-socialist-newspaper/>
- **Firebrand:** Literature blog supporting the following organizations: Seattle Revolutionary Socialists, Firebrand NYC, Denver Communists, Firebrand Boston

Seattle Times

I started with a corpus I had collected of *Seattle Times* last summer, from Wayback Machine/Common Crawl. This corpus contains 500,000 articles spanning 1995ish-2024.

- **Seattle Times (General Opinion Sections):** 2,000 randomly sampled articles from *Seattle Times* Opinion Section
- **Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Articles):** I used an LLM to tag *Seattle Times* articles that were about socialist organizations or socialist themes in a sample of 50,000 articles. Then, I trained a linear classifier to distill these tags and scaled it across the whole corpus.
- **Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Opinion Articles):** Same as above, except only for Opinion articles.
- **Seattle Times (Issue-Matched):** I embedded all *Seattle Times* articles into a retrieval database, then for each socialist article, I queried the database for the closest matches. This helps us find *Seattle Times* articles that are about the same things as socialist articles.

Counts of Articles in Each Corpus

	count
corpus	
Seattle Freedom Socialist Party	3308
Seattle Times (General Opinion Section)	2000
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Articles)	2000
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Opinion)	1397
Seattle Times (Issue-Matched)	1250
Socialist Alternative	331
Seattle DSA	231
Firebrand / Seattle Revolutionary Socialists	73

Definiton of Different Prompts We'll be Looking At:

How complex is this writing?

- Choose from the following options:
- Simple language (i.e. accessible to all readers, straightforward vocabulary)
 - Moderate complexity (i.e. some specialized vocabulary or concepts, generally understandable)
 - Highly technical or specialized (i.e. advanced vocabulary and specialized knowledge required)

Reading Level

	Simple	Moderate	Highly technical
Firebrand / Seattle Revolutionary Socialists	0.00	0.77	0.78
Seattle DSA	0.00	0.99	0.29
Seattle Freedom Socialist Party	0.00	0.97	0.16
Seattle Times (General Opinion Section)	0.02	0.98	0.05
Socialist Alternative	0.02	0.98	0.04
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Opinion)	0.02	0.98	0.03
Seattle Times (Issue-Matched)	0.02	0.98	0.02
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Articles)	0.04	0.97	0.01

How is this writing?

Choose from the following options:

- Narrative (i.e. structured as a story or chronological account)
- Q&A (i.e. structured in a question-and-answer format)
- Interview (i.e. structured as a dialogue with quoted speech)
- Call-to-action (i.e. explicitly urging readers to take specific actions)
- Listicle (i.e. structured as a list of items or points)
- Expository (i.e. structured logically to explain or analyze clearly)
- Other (please specify if possible)

Article-Type

	Narrative	Q&A	Interview	Call-to-action	Listicle	Expository
Firebrand / Seattle Revolutionary Socialists	0.01	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.01	0.97
Seattle Freedom Socialist Party	0.03	0.00	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.91
Seattle DSA	0.02	0.01	0.00	0.05	0.00	0.92
Socialist Alternative	0.02	0.01	0.02	0.06	0.02	0.89
Seattle Times (Issue-Matched)	0.01	0.01	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.98
Seattle Times (General Opinion Section)	0.02	0.00	0.00	0.01	0.00	0.96
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Articles)	0.01	0.01	0.01	0.01	0.01	0.96
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Opinion)	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.01	0.01	0.97

What kind of writing is this?

- Choose from the following options:
- Opinion (i.e. expresses the author's personal views or judgments)
 - Advocacy (i.e. actively promotes a cause, policy, or action)
 - Informational (i.e. aims solely to inform or educate without persuasion)
 - Investigative (i.e. uncovers facts through detailed inquiry or reporting)
 - Other (please specify if possible)``

Writing Tone

	Opinion	Advocacy	Informational
Socialist Alternative	0.01	0.99	0.01
Seattle DSA	0.02	0.93	0.06
Seattle Freedom Socialist Party	0.17	0.87	0.03
Firebrand / Seattle Revolutionary Socialists	0.37	0.74	0.00
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Opinion)	0.69	0.53	0.03
Seattle Times (General Opinion Section)	0.67	0.48	0.03
Seattle Times (Issue-Matched)	0.13	0.09	0.54
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Articles)	0.14	0.03	0.51

What kinds of issues are being discussed in this writing?

Choose from the following options (select all that apply):

- International (i.e. issues affecting multiple countries or global matters)
- National (i.e. issues impacting a specific nation)
- State (i.e. issues specific to a particular state or region within a nation)
- City (i.e. issues pertinent to a specific city)
- Neighborhood / Local (i.e. highly localized community issues)
- Cultural / Social (i.e. issues related to societal norms, values, or culture)
- Environmental (i.e. topics related to nature, climate, or ecology)
- Other (please specify if possible)

Geographic Discourse Level

	International	National	State	City	Neighborhood / Local
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Opinion)	0.05	0.64	0.76	0.72	0.40
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Articles)	0.04	0.67	0.87	0.85	0.38
Seattle DSA	0.16	0.85	0.79	0.84	0.25
Seattle Times (General Opinion Section)	0.27	0.88	0.65	0.28	0.20
Seattle Times (Issue-Matched)	0.21	0.85	0.71	0.51	0.19
Socialist Alternative	0.22	0.92	0.66	0.89	0.14
Seattle Freedom Socialist Party	0.57	0.99	0.43	0.22	0.06
Firebrand / Seattle Revolutionary Socialists	0.73	1.00	0.05	0.04	0.00

What perspective is this writing taking on the events it describes?

Choose from the following options:

- Neutral (i.e. balanced without clear judgment)
- Positive (i.e. highlights positive aspects or benefits)
- Negative (i.e. emphasizes criticism or negative aspects)
- Mixed (i.e. contains both positive and negative perspectives)

Writing Stance

	Positive	Neutral	Negative
Firebrand / Seattle Revolutionary Socialists	0.18	0.01	0.77
Seattle Freedom Socialist Party	0.30	0.01	0.72
Seattle DSA	0.32	0.00	0.71
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Opinion)	0.29	0.04	0.65
Seattle Times (General Opinion Section)	0.34	0.02	0.58
Socialist Alternative	0.59	0.01	0.44
Seattle Times (Issue-Matched)	0.13	0.45	0.34
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Articles)	0.16	0.49	0.23

What is the primary intent or purpose of this article?

Choose from the following options:

- Inform (i.e. provides facts or knowledge without seeking to sway opinion)
- Persuade (i.e. aims to influence beliefs or attitudes)
- Mobilize (i.e. encourages direct action or participation)
- Critique or oppose something (i.e. highlights faults or arguments against a subject)
- Entertain (i.e. aims to amuse or captivate an audience)
- Other (please specify if possible)

Writing Purpose

	Inform	Persuade	Mobilize	Critique or oppose something
Firebrand / Seattle Revolutionary Socialists	0.03	0.82	0.03	0.12
Seattle Times (General Opinion Section)	0.07	0.81	0.02	0.09
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Opinion)	0.05	0.79	0.03	0.14
Seattle Freedom Socialist Party	0.05	0.72	0.14	0.09
Socialist Alternative	0.01	0.59	0.39	0.01
Seattle DSA	0.08	0.57	0.32	0.04
Seattle Times (Issue-Matched)	0.80	0.16	0.01	0.04
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Articles)	0.84	0.11	0.02	0.03

Does the writing seek reader engagement? If so, how?

Choose from the following options (select all that apply):

- Asking for comments or feedback (i.e. explicitly invites readers to provide thoughts or opinions)
- Encouraging sharing on social media (i.e. suggests that readers post or forward content on social platforms)
- Soliciting donations or support (i.e. requests financial contributions, membership, or volunteer help)
- Drawing readers in with personal stories or questions (i.e. presents relatable narratives or poses direct questions to captivate interest)
- Interactive elements (e.g. polls, quizzes) (i.e. includes interactive tools prompting reader input)
- No engagement sought (i.e. does not request reader involvement)
- Other forms of engagement (please specify if possible)

Writing Goal

	Asking for comments	Encouraging sharing on social media	Soliciting donations or support	No engagement sought
Seattle Times (Issue-Matched)	0.03	0.04	0.02	0.82
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Articles)	0.05	0.04	0.03	0.81
Firebrand / Seattle Revolutionary Socialists	0.00	0.01	0.26	0.66
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Opinion)	0.08	0.01	0.06	0.57
Seattle Times (General Opinion Section)	0.10	0.02	0.06	0.45
Seattle Freedom Socialist Party	0.09	0.01	0.25	0.34
Socialist Alternative	0.00	0.14	0.60	0.21
Seattle DSA	0.03	0.12	0.53	0.20

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Are rhetorical devices used in this writing? If so, which ones?

Choose from the following options (select all that apply):

- Metaphors or similes (i.e. figurative language comparing unlike things)
- Appeals to emotion (e.g., fear, pride, hope)
- Sarcasm or humor (i.e. ironic, humorous, or sarcastic expressions)
- Slogans or catchphrases (i.e. repeated phrases for memorability or emphasis)
- Repetition (i.e. reiterating words or ideas for emphasis)
- Other rhetorical devices (please specify if possible)
- No rhetorical devices observed

Rhetorical Devices

	Metaphors or similes	Sarcasm or humor	Slogans or catchphrases	No rhetorical devices observed
Socialist Alternative	0.29	0.25	0.63	0.01
Seattle DSA	0.63	0.60	0.61	0.01
Seattle Freedom Socialist Party	0.63	0.58	0.42	0.01
Firebrand / Seattle Revolutionary Socialists	0.74	0.36	0.23	0.00
Seattle Times (Socialist- Focused Articles)	0.29	0.28	0.23	0.08
Seattle Times (Issue- Matched)	0.28	0.24	0.20	0.09
Seattle Times (Socialist- Focused Opinion)	0.39	0.53	0.14	0.01
Seattle Times (General Opinion Section)	0.53	0.51	0.12	0.01

Who appears to be the intended audience for this writing?

Choose from the following options:

- General public (i.e. broad, mainstream audience with no specialized knowledge needed)
- Existing supporters (i.e. already aligned audience, reinforcing their existing views or involvement)
- Potential new supporters (i.e. seeks to convert or attract new participants, members, or customers)
- Opponents (i.e. addresses those who hold opposing views or might be skeptical)
- Other (please specify if possible)

Intended Audience

	General public	Existing supporters	Potential new supporters	Opponents	Other
Firebrand / Seattle Revolutionary Socialists	0.00	0.92	0.12	0.03	0.00
Seattle DSA	0.02	0.86	0.13	0.00	0.00
Seattle Freedom Socialist Party	0.06	0.80	0.14	0.01	0.00
Socialist Alternative	0.02	0.77	0.25	0.00	0.00
Seattle Times (General Opinion Section)	0.89	0.04	0.04	0.03	0.00
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Opinion)	0.89	0.03	0.04	0.04	0.00
Seattle Times (Issue-Matched)	0.97	0.02	0.01	0.00	0.00
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Articles)	0.98	0.01	0.01	0.00	0.00

Is there a timely hook or event prompting this article?

Choose from the following options:

- Reaction to recent events (i.e. triggered by current or recent events)
- Anticipation of upcoming events (i.e. related to forthcoming events)
- Anniversary or historical significance (i.e. connected to historical anniversaries or milestones)
- Seasonal or recurring event (i.e. connected to seasonal or periodically recurring events)
- General / no specific event (i.e. not tied to any particular timing)

Relation to Current Events

	Reaction to recent events	Anticipation of upcoming events	Anniversary or historical significance	General / no specific event
Firebrand / Seattle Revolutionary Socialists	0.70	0.04	0.01	0.25
Seattle Freedom Socialist Party	0.80	0.06	0.04	0.09
Seattle DSA	0.84	0.10	0.00	0.04
<i>Seattle Times</i> (General Opinion Section)	0.79	0.12	0.02	0.04
<i>Seattle Times</i> (Issue-Matched)	0.82	0.12	0.03	0.02
Socialist Alternative	0.83	0.13	0.03	0.00
<i>Seattle Times</i> (Socialist-Focused Opinion)	0.79	0.16	0.01	0.02
<i>Seattle Times</i> (Socialist-Focused Articles)	0.73	0.19	0.02	0.04

What tone does this writing take?

Choose from the following options:

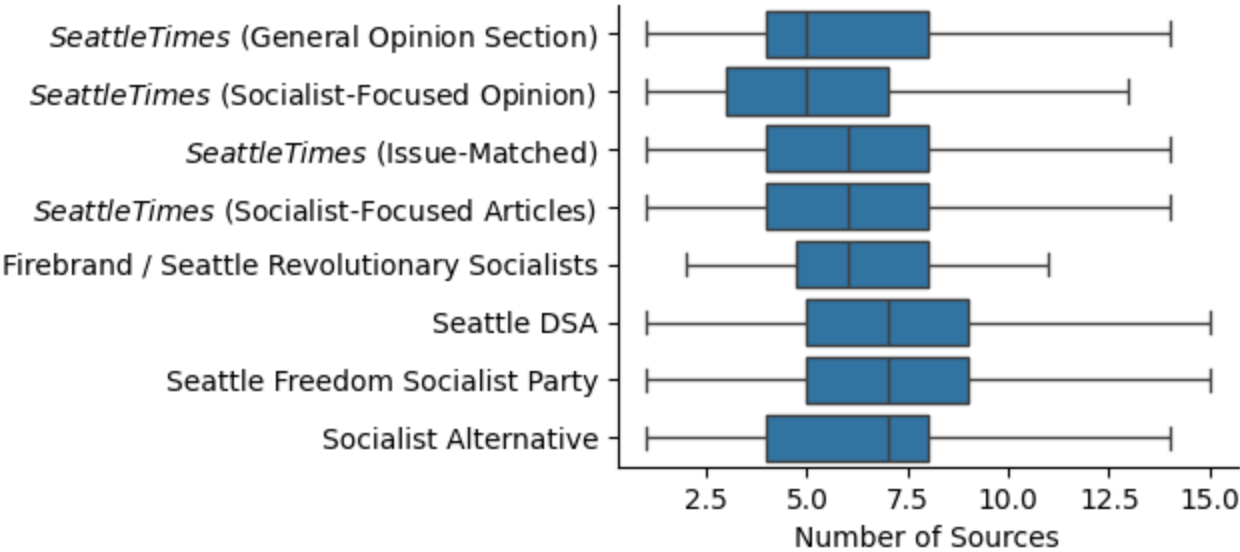
- Formal / Academic (i.e. serious, professional, or scholarly tone)
- Informal / Conversational (i.e. casual, approachable, friendly tone)
- Provocative (i.e. intended to provoke thought or reaction)
- Inspirational / Motivational (i.e. aims to inspire or encourage action or positivity)
- Alarmist / Sensational (i.e. exaggerates urgency or threats)
- Humorous / Satirical (i.e. employs humor, satire, or wit)
- Other (please specify if possible)

Writing Tone

	Formal	Academic	Informal	Conversational	Provocative	Inspirational	Motivator
Socialist Alternative	0.92	0.45	0.55	0.55	0.98	0.95	0.9
Seattle Freedom Socialist Party	0.82	0.39	0.47	0.47	0.98	0.74	0.9
Seattle DSA	0.94	0.26	0.75	0.75	0.95	0.70	0.9
Firebrand / Seattle Revolutionary Socialists	0.95	0.82	0.19	0.19	1.00	0.45	0.9
Seattle Times (General Opinion Section)	0.99	0.60	0.51	0.51	0.91	0.44	0.9
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Opinion)	0.99	0.63	0.47	0.47	0.96	0.40	0.9
Seattle Times (Issue-Matched)	0.99	0.86	0.39	0.39	0.73	0.16	0.9
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Articles)	0.99	0.78	0.58	0.58	0.74	0.15	0.9

Source Prompts

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Text(0.5, 0, 'Number of Sources')
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Give a generic keyword label to categorize the narrative role the source plays in the article.

	count
Narrative Function Label	
Counterpoint	3875
Narrator	2959
Authority	2533
Victim	1619
Antagonist	1420
Protagonist	1280
Main Actor	954
Evidence	854
Supporter	810
Expert	753

Source Narrative Function

Narrative Function Label	Antagonist	Authority	Counterpoint	Evidence	Main Actor	Narrator	Protagonist	Victim
Seattle Freedom Socialist Party	0.15	0.13	0.20	0.05	0.05	0.21	0.10	0.12
Seattle DSA	0.18	0.11	0.19	0.05	0.04	0.22	0.08	0.13
Socialist Alternative	0.13	0.08	0.20	0.06	0.08	0.23	0.12	0.09
Seattle Times (Issue-Matched)	0.03	0.22	0.28	0.05	0.07	0.17	0.07	0.11
Seattle Times (General Opinion Section)	0.07	0.23	0.27	0.07	0.07	0.16	0.07	0.05
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Articles)	0.02	0.18	0.31	0.05	0.08	0.20	0.07	0.09
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Opinion)	0.07	0.20	0.32	0.09	0.06	0.14	0.05	0.08

Perspective: What is their perspective on the main events of the article? Choose as many labels as fit from: ["Authoritative", "Informative", "Supportive", "Skeptical", "Against", "Neutral"].

Source Perspective

Perspective	Against	Authoritative	Informative	Neutral	Skeptical	Supportive
Socialist Alternative	0.16	0.13	0.22	0.06	0.02	0.41
Seattle DSA	0.19	0.13	0.24	0.06	0.02	0.36
Seattle Freedom Socialist Party	0.19	0.15	0.25	0.06	0.03	0.33
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Articles)	0.11	0.15	0.31	0.11	0.05	0.27
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Opinion)	0.15	0.17	0.29	0.08	0.04	0.27
Seattle Times (Issue-Matched)	0.12	0.16	0.30	0.11	0.03	0.27
Seattle Times (General Opinion Section)	0.13	0.18	0.31	0.07	0.04	0.26

Centrality: How central is this source to the main events of the article?
Choose from "High", "Medium", "Low".

Centrality

Centrality	High	Low	Medium
Seattle Freedom Socialist Party	0.37	0.19	0.45
Seattle DSA	0.35	0.21	0.44
Socialist Alternative	0.39	0.19	0.42
Seattle Times (Issue-Matched)	0.36	0.20	0.44
Seattle Times (General Opinion Section)	0.38	0.19	0.43
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Articles)	0.35	0.21	0.44
Seattle Times (Socialist-Focused Opinion)	0.39	0.18	0.43

Closed Set Prompts

